THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

MACC7014 ESG, Risk Management and Advanced Corporate Control

"Harnessing the Power of Numbers for Managerial Decision-Making"

GENERAL INFORMATION

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COURSE DESCRIPTION AND OBJECTIVES

The primary purpose of managerial accounting, and the main goal of this course, is to learn how to provide superior information to those running a company so that they can make better decisions and more successfully compete for customers, suppliers, employees, and so forth. In short, good managerial accounting is a competitive tool we want to learn how to use.

Because a managerial accounting system is (or can be) a competitive tool, the practice of managerial accounting involves innovation, experimentation, diversity, success, and failure as businesses tinker with their managerial accounting systems to create superior information for decision-making. Certainly, there are "best practices" in managerial accounting; you will learn about them in this course. But remember that a good business is always re-examining its internal information system to see whether the system can be coaxed into providing better, timelier data.

Our course will:

1. Provide students with advanced concepts in strategic management control and the usefulness of management accounting systems;
    - Understand concepts of strategy, environmental factors, and performance.
    - Discuss the impact of risks and uncertainties on organizational performance.
    - Use strategic management control systems to support the execution of organizational strategy.
    - Discuss specific topics in strategic management internal control systems.
    - Use management accounting information in decisions.
2. Provide students with the capability to apply knowledge in decision-making scenarios using case analysis. Introduce data analytics skills in the context of management control.
3. Develop students' teamwork, leadership, and professional communication skills using case analysis and presentations.
4. Provide students with advanced concepts in strategic management control and the usefulness of management accounting systems;
    - Understand concepts of strategy, environmental factors and performance.
    - Discuss the impact of risks and uncertainties on organizational performance.
    - Use strategic management control systems to support the execution of organizational strategy.
    - Discuss specific topics in strategic management control systems.
    - Use management accounting information in decisions.
5. Provide students with the capability to apply knowledge in decision-making scenarios using case analysis. Introduce data analytics skills in the context of management control.
6. Develop students' teamwork, leadership, and professional communication skills using case analysis and presentations.

Specific topics that we will explore during this course and in which students should gain proficiency are as follows:

- Cost flows and product costing

- Cost-volume-profit analysis
- Budgeting
- Performance evaluation
- Relevant costs and the making of special decisions
- Balanced Scorecard
- Capital Budgeting
- Risk Management (Enterprise, Strategic, Cyber)
- Internal Control Policies and Implementation

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES (AND ALIGNED CLOS)

Programme Learning Outcomes	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
PLO1: Acquiring and internalizing accounting and business knowledge and skills	CLO1, CLO2, CLO3
PLO2: Applying and integrating accounting and business knowledge	CLO2, CLO3, CLO4, CLO6
PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership	CLO3, CLO4, CLO5
PLO4: Developing a global outlook	CLO4, CLO5, CLO6
PLO5: Mastering communication skills	CLO4, CLO5

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

On successful completion of this course, students should be able to:

CLO1	Understand the core concepts of financial reporting and related practices, including the development and implementation of appropriate internal control practices
CLO2	Analyze and interpret key financial statements using financial ratios and their inter- relationships for sound decision making
CLO3	Understand core management and financial control techniques that link accounting information to the planning, organizing, and control functions of management
CLO4	Analyze and present business cases with decision recommendations
CLO5	Learn teamwork and communication skills through a group case project
CLO6	Analyze sources and types of risk (enterprise, strategic, cyber) and develop tools and strategies for managing these risks in an ever-evolving environment.

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	**Expected contact hour**	**Study Load (% of study)**
T&L1. Interactive Lectures	33	27.5%
T&L2. Case study and group presentation	30	25%
T&L3. Self-study	57	47.5%
Total	120	100%

T&L1. Interactive lectures

- Lectures: the advanced knowledge of management accounting is presented with PowerPoint slides.
- In-class exercises: application techniques are illustrated using examples. Students work through in-class exercises along with the lecturer. These exercises help students follow the lectures closely and actively.
- In-class discussions: students are encouraged to raise questions, participate in discussions and share opinions with their peers. These discussions encourage students to think more for certain arguable topics.

T&L2. Case study and group presentations

- Case analyses: Students are required to form groups to analyze assigned business cases. The assigned cases cover different management accounting topics, such as, cost allocation and performance measurement systems. These practices help students improve critical thinking abilities, research and group work skills.

- Group discussions and in-class presentations: Students are divided into groups to finish the case project. Group members meet to discuss the case, work on the case as a team and contribute jointly to the oral presentation for timely submission. Students are required to present assigned business cases and hold Q&A sessions to address questions and concerns raised by the rest of the class.

Assessment Methods	**Brief Description (Optional)**	**Weight**	**Aligned Course Learning Outcomes**
Attendance and participation in lecture and discussion	Students are expected to attend and participate actively in lectures and discussion. Quietly sitting in the class does not count, but of course absenteeism from class will negatively affect the performance. Students are also required to attempt selected assignments. Participation and assignments are evaluated per student by the lecturer and demonstrator.	20%	CLO 1, 2 ,3, 4, 6
Case presentation	Case presentations will be prepared on a group basis. Each group is responsible for one case, by giving a 20-30 minutes presentation, plus 5-10 minutes Q&A session. Cases will be assigned on a preference/random basis. The date for the case presentation is shown on the attached "Schedule of lectures". Each group of students is expected to submit the PowerPoint slides on the day of presentation. The objective of the case presentation is to help students apply the knowledge into real-life situations and improve communication skills.	30%	CLO 1, 2, 3, 4, 6
Final Exam	The final examination will be held in the normal exam period. It is a closed book comprehensive examination which covers all the chapters on the course syllabus. With the exception of extremely special cases, NO MAKEUP test will be allowed if students fail to seek ADVANCE permission from the instructor. The objective of the final exam is to further enhance students' understanding of the concepts and theories and develop their ability to apply the knowledge learned in the classes.	50%	CLO 1, 2
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+ A A-	Demonstrate evidence of original thought, strong analytical and critical abilities as well as a thorough grasp of the topic from background reading and analysis; should demonstrate excellent organizational and presentational skills.
B+ B B-	Demonstrate evidence of critical and analytical thinking but not necessarily original in their thinking; show an adequate grasp of the topic from background reading and analysis; should demonstrate strong organizational and presentational skills.
C+ C C-	Demonstrate evidence of a reasonable grasp of their subject but most of their information is derivative, with rather little evidence of critical thinking; should demonstrate fair organizational and presentational skills.
D+ D	Demonstrate evidence of being able to assemble the bare minimum of information, poorly digested and not very well organized in presentation. There is no evidence of critical thinking.
F	Demonstrate evidence of poor knowledge and understanding of the subject, a lack of coherence and organization, and answers are largely irrelevant. Work fails to reach degree level.

Assessment Rubrics for Each Assessment

AT1. Attendance and participation in lecture and discussion (20%)

A+, A, A-	Extremely well prepared for class discussion, active in sharing views and attended at least 90% of classes.
B+, B, B-	Partially prepared for class discussion, quite active in sharing views and attended at least 80% of classes
C+, C, C-	Not well prepared for class discussion, limited active in sharing views and attended at least 70% of classes.
D+, D	Not well prepared for class discussion, no sharing of views and attended at least 60% of classes
F - Fail	Never prepared for class discussion and no sharing of views and experience and attended less than 50% of classes.

AT2. Case presentation (30%)	
A+, A, A-	The presentation was highly successful at communicating the essential elements of the topic to the audience. Concepts were thoroughly explained and clarified. The presentation demonstrated deep understanding and comprehension of the topic. There was clear evidence of independent thought and reflection on the topic. The topic was covered in a highly professional and organized manner. The presenter displayed excellent verbal skills and delivered a highly interesting, coherent presentation at an appropriate level for the audience.
B+, B, B-	The presentation was successful at communicating the essential elements of the topic to the audience. Most concepts were well explained and clarified. The presentation demonstrated sound understanding and comprehension of most aspects of the topic. The topic was covered in a professional and organized manner. The presenter displayed good verbal skills and mostly delivered an interesting, coherent presentation at an appropriate level for the audience.
C+, C, C-	The presentation adequately communicated most of the essential elements of the topic to the audience. Most concepts were adequately explained. The presentation demonstrated good understanding and comprehension of most aspects of the topic. The topic was covered in an organized manner. The presenter displayed adequate verbal skills and mostly delivered a coherent presentation at an appropriate level for the audience.
D+, D	The presentation basically covered the main aspects of the topic. The presentation demonstrated basic understanding and comprehension of most of the topic. The topic was covered in a basic manner. The presenter displayed minimal standards of verbal skills and or coherence and organization.
F - Fail	The presentation was poorly addressed and or concepts were inadequately explained. The presentation did not demonstrate sufficient understanding and comprehension of the topic. The topic was not covered acceptably and or was poorly organized. Verbal skills were inadequate.
AT3. Final Exam (50%)	
A+, A, A-	Provided accurate solutions to all problems, gave detailed and insightful responses to essay questions and scored correctly on more than 90% of the multiple-choice questions
B+, B, B-	Provided accurate solutions to some problems, gave detailed responses to some essay questions and scored correctly on less than 90% of the multiple-choice questions.
C+, C, C-	Provided accurate solutions to a few problems, gave limited responses to some essay questions and scored correctly on less than 80% of the multiple-choice questions.
D+, D	Provided inaccurate solutions to a few problems, gave unclear responses to most essay questions and scored correctly on less than 70% of the multiple-choice questions.
F - Fail	Skipped some problems or provided inaccurate solutions to most problems, gave poor responses to most essay questions and scored correctly on less than 60% of the multiple-choice questions.

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

1. Cost information in decision makings
   (1) Pricing decisions
   (2) Customer relationship management
   (3) Capacity management
   (4) Transfer pricing
   (5) Risk management
2. ABC/M and its application in the real world
   (1) Design of an ABC system
   (2) How to use information from an ABC system

3. Strategic performance management systems

   (1) Design of a SPMS

   (2) Link to compensation

   (3) Internal control systems

4. Management control & leadership in an organization

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS

Text/Learning Materials

- *Online Learning Tool*
  - In lieu of a textbook, the recommended materials for our class are online materials from Myeducator.com. The online class materials provide additional reading/videos/practice problems for the topics covered in our class.

The MyEducator learning tool is accessed ONLINE. Follow the steps below.

- Similar to a recommended textbook, it is not required to use the online materials at MyEducator, though it is recommended. To access the materials, you will need to purchase a subscription to the MyEducator course content. The cost is $USD50 – HKU students have been given a special discount. The cost in North America and Europe is $USD80.
- To purchase a subscription, please go to the following page:

  https://app.myeducator.com/s/2G6Ojd0T601/

- The system will ask you for your email address. After you enter your email address, you will be asked a very simple security email question. Once you answer this question, you will receive an email message explaining how to create your new password.
- After you have created your new password, go to the following login page to log onto the course:

  https://go.myeducator.com/account/

- Input your email address as well as the password that you just created. Once you are in the system, you will see the HKU managerial accounting course on your welcome screen.
- If you have any trouble getting into the course, send an email to info@myeducator.com or to me directly at dstice@hku.hk.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

1. Quantitative feedback will be provided via the course website on Moodle.
2. Qualitative feedback will be provided via face-to-face discussions with students during or after class (e.g., office hours).
3. Students are encouraged to make appointments with the teacher to discuss issues related to the course. Email communication is also welcome.
4. The SFTL questionnaire.

COURSE POLICY

A student's academic responsibility, such as issues of plagiarism is often highlighted in a course outline and other academic issues or procedures which may be pertinent to a specific program or course.

1. Plagiarism and copying of copyright materials are serious offences and may lead to disciplinary actions. You should read the chapters on "Plagiarism" and "Copyright" in the Undergraduate/Postgraduate Handbook for details. You are strongly advised to read the booklet entitled "What is Plagiarism" which was distributed to you upon your admission into the University, a copy of which can be found at www.hku.hk/plagiarism. A booklet entitled "Plagiarism and How to Avoid it" is also available from the Main Library.

2. The course enrollment is charged by the faculty office. Please approach the staff in the faculty office for any queries about course enrollment, class quota, etc.

3. There is no make-up test for the mid-term test. If you are absent from the midterm test without eligible reasons/documents, you will not earn any marks on the mid-term test. If you are absent from the mid-term test with

eligible reasons/documents, your score on the final exam will be applied higher weight (including weight on final exam and mid-term test).

4. There is no make-up session for the oral presentation. If you are absent from the oral presentation without eligible reasons/documents, you will not earn any marks on the oral presentation. If you are absent from the oral presentation with eligible reasons/documents, your score on the final exam will be applied higher weight (including weight on the final exam and oral presentation).
   A make-up exam will be given if you miss the final exam with valid reasons/documents.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION

- This course will utilize MOODLE.
- The course syllabus is tentative and subject to revisions.